Arolygiaeth Gofal Cymru
Care Inspectorate Wales

Inspection Report

Briarswood Residential Home

67 Trosserch Road, Llangennech, Llanelli, SA14 8AX

01554820585

The inspection visit took place on 18/06/2026

Service Information:

Operated by:	Elizabeth Thomas
Care Type:	Care Home Service Adults Without Nursing
Provision for:	Care home for adults - with personal care, Provision for learning disability, Provision for mental health
Registered places:	6
Main language(s):	English
Promotion of Welsh language and culture:	The provider makes an effort to promote the use of the Welsh language and culture or is working towards a bilingual service.

Ratings:

Well-being	Good
Care & Support	Good
Environment	Good
Leadership & Management	Good

Summary:

Briarswood is a small, friendly, family run home on the outskirts of Llanelli, providing support to people with learning disabilities.

People have good wellbeing outcomes because they have choice and control over their day to day lives and are involved in decisions that affect them. They are treated with dignity, kindness and compassion from care staff who know them well. People are supported to do the things that matter to them.

Care and support are good and personal plans are detailed, up to date and inform care staff on how best to support people. Care is provided by a small, stable team that provide consistency and have a good understanding of people's needs.

The environment is comfortable and homely, and people are supported to remain active within their community. We identified that some actions are required to optimise fire safety as advised by the Fire Service. This is an area for improvement and we expect the provider to address this as a priority.

Leadership and management is good and care staff feel supported and valued. Governance arrangements are generally effective, although further formalisation of auditing and quality assurance systems would strengthen this area.

Findings:

Well-being — Good

People are supported to achieve positive well-being outcomes and live in a home where they are valued, respected and treated with dignity. We observed warm, caring and meaningful interactions between staff and people living at the home. People appeared relaxed, comfortable and at ease in the presence of staff, demonstrating positive and trusting relationships.

People are encouraged and supported to make choices about their day-to-day lives. Records demonstrated that personal preferences and individual wishes are recognised and respected. Care documentation included accessible information, photographs and pictorial formats to support understanding and participation in decisions. We saw people choosing what they wanted to eat for breakfast and lunch and they are empowered to prepare their own meals.

People are supported to maintain good health and access the relevant professionals when required. Care records evidenced involvement from health and social care professionals, and discussions with staff demonstrated a good understanding of people's individual needs.

People are encouraged to remain active and participate in activities meaningful to them. Individuals access community resources, enjoy hobbies and maintain relationships with family and friends, if appropriate. Professionals told us people are happy living at the service and considered it their home. One person spoke positively about attending activities in the community and maintaining important social connections.

People are protected from abuse and neglect. Safeguarding arrangements are in place and staff have an understanding of their responsibilities for keeping people safe. Risk assessments are comprehensive and reflect people's individual circumstances whilst promoting independence and positive risk-taking.

Care & Support — Good

People receive personalised care and support that reflects their assessed needs and desired outcomes. We reviewed care records and found detailed, person-centred plans containing comprehensive information about people's histories, preferences, health conditions, support needs and personal aspirations. Documentation is written respectfully and in a format accessible to the individuals concerned. Records demonstrating how people achieve their personal outcomes could be further strengthened by including more detailed evaluative information.

Risk assessments are detailed, regularly reviewed and provide clear guidance for staff. Specialist plans are in place where required, including behaviour support and management of certain health conditions. Staff demonstrate a clear understanding of people's needs and how support should be delivered safely and consistently.

People experience continuity of care through a stable staff team that know them well. Discussions with a professional confirmed that people have positive relationships with staff and benefit from consistent support. Staff work effectively with external professionals to ensure people's health and well-being needs are met.

Medication arrangements are generally safe. Medicines are stored securely, temperature checks are completed, staff have received relevant training and medication administration records (MAR) sampled were appropriately completed. Controlled drug arrangements are in place and stock balances corresponded with records. Although the manager undertakes regular medication checks, these are currently not formally recorded. Formal medication audits would strengthen oversight arrangements.

Infection prevention and control measures are effective and appropriate. The environment is clean, tidy and well stocked with personal protective equipment. Staff have completed infection prevention and control training and appropriate hygiene practices were evident throughout the inspection.

Environment

Good

People live in a comfortable, homely environment that supports their well-being. Bedrooms are personalised with photographs, personal possessions and items of significance to individuals. People have access to communal areas and safe outdoor spaces which they enjoy using. One person is supported to pursue their interest in gardening and enjoys maintaining plants within the grounds.

The home is clean, tidy and well maintained. Appropriate arrangements are in place for the storage of hazardous substances and equipment. Safety measures such as window restrictors, fire safety systems and secure storage facilities were evident.

We reviewed maintenance and servicing arrangements and found evidence of ongoing checks, including fire safety monitoring. The fire service has recently completed a safety check and have recommended some minor adjustments. The provider has begun this work however some actions are outstanding. We have identified this as an area for improvement and expect this to be addressed as a priority.

Appropriate facilities are available to meet the needs of people living at the service. People are supported within an environment that promotes independence and enables access to communal and outdoor areas. The premises provide a homely and familiar setting which contributes positively to people's sense of home and belonging

Some areas of the premises would benefit from refurbishment, including flooring in communal areas and carpet in one bedroom. Whilst these issues were not having a significant impact on people currently living at the home, elements of décor and furnishings are showing some signs of wear.

Leadership & Management — Good

The proprietor is the manager and although is not registered as the Responsible Individual, is the appointed person who takes on this role. There is good oversight of the service and the manager is actively involved and present at the service most days. A small but dedicated team work closely together to ensure smooth running of the service. The manager covers a high number of shifts to ensure people continue to receive care and support from staff they know well. The provider is required to register the service to meet legal and regulatory requirements. We saw positive relationships between management, staff and people receiving care.

There is a stable and suitably trained staff team. Staff receive induction, supervision, appraisal and ongoing training to support them in their roles. Staff are registered with Social Care Wales and training records demonstrated that mandatory training requirements are being met.

The service works with professionals and external agencies to support good outcomes for people. One professional told us, "*From day one they have been extremely accommodating. They have supported them and ensured that every activity during their break has been focused on them. They have supported us in emergencies and staff have been professional and supportive through out. The management have got back to us straight away if we have had to contact them and always accommodated where they have been able too".*

Policies and procedures are available and a sample have been reviewed. These were comprehensive and relevant and are evaluated by the manager regularly. Systems for recording incidents, safeguarding matters and notifications are in place. Feedback mechanisms and satisfaction surveys are used to gather views about the quality of the service.

Staff described receiving good support from management and confirmed they had access to training and supervision. Staffing levels were suitable to meet the needs of people currently living at the home.

Whilst quality assurance arrangements are in place, we found some audits were being undertaken informally but not consistently documented. Formal recording of governance activity would strengthen provider oversight and provide clearer evidence of quality monitoring.

Areas identified for improvement

Where we identify **Areas for Improvement** but we have not found outcomes for people to be at immediate or significant risk, we discuss these with the provider. We expect the provider to take action and we will follow this up at the next inspection.

Where we find outcomes for people **require significant improvement** and/or there is risk to people's well-being we identify areas for **Priority Action**. In these circumstances we issue a Priority Action Notice(s) to the Provider, and they must take immediate steps to make improvements. We will inspect again within six months to check improvements have been made and outcomes for people have improved.

The table(s) below show the area(s) for priority action and/or those for improvement we have identified.

Summary of Areas for Improvement	Date identified
The provider is required to complete actions identified by the Fire service to ensure people and staff are as safe as possible in the even of a fire. If this is not done people are at increased risk as a fire may not be detected as early as it could be.	18/06/26

CIW has not issued any Priority action notices following this inspection.

Welsh Government © Crown copyright 2026.
You may use and re-use the information featured in this publication (not including logos) free of charge in any format or medium, under the terms of the Open Government License. You can view the Open Government License, on the National Archives website or you can write to the Information Policy Team, The National Archives, Kew, London TW9 4DU, or email: psi@nationalarchives.gov.uk
You must reproduce our material accurately and not use it in a misleading context.